

# 考研精读 | Economist



## Families scramble to secure Send plans ahead of ministers' reforms

改革落地前夕，英国家庭争相申请特殊教育需求扶持计划

难度评级: ★★☆☆☆

### 【 Para.1 】

Schools and councils in England are expecting the proportion of children with special needs plans to double to one in 10, as families rush to secure support before changes come in. Headteachers have reported an “unreal” surge in applications for education, health and care plans (EHCPs) **mandating** support for needs or disabilities such as speech and learning difficulties, **autism** or ADHD. In 2025, just one in 20 school-age children had EHCPs.

英格兰各地学校与地方议会预计：大量家庭急着在新政落地前为孩子申办特殊教育需求扶持计划，将使受该政策覆盖的儿童比例翻倍，升至 1/10。校长们反映，“教育、健康、护理计划（EHCP）”的申请人数出现“令人难以置信”的激增。这份计划规定：必须为存在言语障碍、学习困难、自闭症、注意缺陷多动

7 September 2026 | The Guardian

### 文章导读：

本文指出，英国特殊教育帮扶计划（EHCP）在新政出台前迎来申请热潮。近两年持证学生数量持续高速增长，预计未来三年保持两位数增速。新政计划从 2030 年起，仅向重度特殊需求儿童开放 EHCP。申请激增加重地方财政压力，各地上调增长预期，民众也对政策调整心存顾虑。

**mandate v.** /'mændət/ If a law or rule mandates something, it orders that it must happen. 强制执行；授权【考研英语大纲词汇】

The law **mandates** safety training for all new employees. 法律规定所有新员工必须参加安全培训。

SYN authorize, prescribe

OPP prohibit

**autism n.** /'ɔ:tɪzəm/ Autism is a developmental condition affecting social communication and interaction. 自闭症；孤独症【非考研英语大纲词汇】文中指儿童的特殊发育障碍，属于 SEND（特殊教育需求）范畴

**double-digit adj.** /ˌdʌbl 'dɪdʒɪt/ A double-digit number or percentage is between 10 and 99. 两位数的【非考研英语大纲词汇】文中 double-digit annual increases 指“两位数的年增长率”

**outstrip v.** /ˌaʊt'strɪp/ If one thing outstrips another, it becomes larger, better or faster than the other. 超过；胜过【考研英语大纲词汇】

Demand for housing has **outstripped** the supply in this city. 这座城市的住房需求已经超过供给。

SYN surpass, exceed

OPP lag behind

**strain v.** /streɪn/ To strain a system or resource means to put heavy pressure on it. 使不堪重负；使受压【考研英语大纲词汇】文中 straining school and council budgets 表示给学校和市政预算造成巨大压力

The sudden arrival of refugees **strained** local public services. 难民的突然到来让当地公共服务不堪重负。

SYN burden, stress

**influx n.** /'ɪnflʌks/ An influx of people or things is a large quantity arriving suddenly. 涌入；大量到来【考研英语大纲词汇】文中 the influx of requests 指评估申请大量涌入

**amass v.** /ə'mæs/ If you amass something, you gradually collect a large amount of it. 积累；积聚【考研英语大纲词汇】文中 amassing sustained deficits 指累积持续的财政赤字

He **amassed** a large fortune through decades of hard work. 他通过数十年奋斗积累了大笔财富。

SYN accumulate, gather

OPP dissipate

**statutory adj.** /'stætʃətəri/ If something is statutory, it is fixed or required by law. 法定的；法律规定的【考研英语大纲词汇】文中 statutory override 指\*\*法定豁免权\*\*，由中央政府依法授予的特殊许可

障碍（ADHD）等特殊需求或残障的儿童提供支持。

2025 年，仅有 1/20 的学龄儿童持有 EHCP。

## 【 Para.2 】

The number of pupils with EHCPs has risen by more than 11% in each of the last two years, and projections by local authorities seen by the Guardian are anticipating **double-digit** annual increases over the next three years. Similar levels nationally would translate to almost 10% of all school-age children having an EHCP in 2029.

过去两年，持有 EHCP 的学生人数每年增幅均超过 11%。《卫报》获取的地方政府预测显示，未来三年，年度增长率都将维持两位数水平。如果全国均按此态势发展，到 2029 年，EHCP 将覆盖近 10% 的学龄儿童。

**override n.** /ˌəʊvəˈraɪd/ An override is an official permission to ignore normal rules. (官方) 特许豁免；越权许可【非考研大纲词汇】文中 statutory override 法律特许豁免，政府准许地方突破财政法规

**profound adj.** /prəˈfaʊnd/ Having a very great or intense quality; serious and deep-seated. 深度的；严重的；意义深远的【考研大纲词汇】

**tangible adj.** /ˈtændʒəbl/ Something tangible is real and can be clearly seen or experienced. 切实的；可感知的【考研大纲词汇】

The policy has brought tangible benefits to ordinary residents. 这项政策给普通居民带来了实实在在的好处。  
SYN concrete, substantial  
OPP intangible

**inclusive adj.** /ɪnˈkluːsɪv/ An inclusive system or society includes all groups of people fairly. 包容的；兼顾各类群体的【考研大纲词汇】文中 inclusive system 指面向残障、特殊需求群体的包容性教育体系

The school is committed to building an inclusive learning environment. 这所学校致力于打造包容的学习环境。  
SYN integrative  
OPP exclusive

## 【 Para.3 】

Such a rapid rise would **outstrip** the government's own forecasts and eat into funding for improving specialist support in mainstream schools, undermining plans for reform while **straining** school and council budgets. School leaders said special educational needs (Send) coordinators had worked through the summer to deal with the **influx** of requests for assessments, as secondary schools reported that many more year 7 students were arriving with EHCPs or applications.

如此迅猛的增长将超出政府自身的预测，挤占普通学校专项帮扶经费，不仅会削弱改革成效，还会加重学校与地方议会的财政压力。许多学校负责人表示，整

个暑假，特殊教育需求协调员都在处理大量新增的评估申请；许多中学反馈，升入七年级的新生中，持有计划或正在提交申请的学生数量大幅增加。

#### 【 Para.4 】

Bill Revans, the County Councils Network's spokesperson on special educational needs and disabilities as well as Liberal Democrat leader of Somerset council, said: "It is clear there has been a particularly sharp surge in assessment requests to our member councils this year since the government announced its planned reforms in February. Our previous analysis had predicted the number of EHCPs will rise to 840,000 by 2028-29; however, it is now likely these numbers will be exceeded.

郡议会网络特殊教育需求与残障事务发言人、萨默塞特郡议会自由民主党领袖比尔·雷万斯（Bill Revans）称：“自政府 2 月公布改革以来，今年各成员郡议会收到的评估申请激增。我们早前预计，到 2028-2029 年，EHCP 持有者的数量将达到 84 万，但从当前趋势看，实际数字很可能高于这一预估。”

#### 【 Para.5 】

EHCPs are legal documents agreed between local authorities and families in England detailing the support required for children and young people up to the age of 25, allowing access to extra funding or places in special schools. While more than 530,000 school-age children have

### ►今日句子分析

Para 3. School leaders said special educational needs (Send) coordinators had worked through the summer to deal with the influx of requests for assessments, as secondary schools reported that many more year 7 students were arriving with EHCPs or applications. (许多学校负责人表示，整个暑假，特殊教育需求协调员都在处理大量新增的评估申请；许多中学反馈，升入七年级的新生中，持有计划或正在提交申请的学生数量大幅增加。)

School leaders said special educational needs (Send)

主 谓 宾语从句

coordinators had worked through the summer to deal with the influx of requests for assessments, as secondary

状语从句

schools reported that many more year 7 students were arriving with EHCPs or applications.

主句:

主语: School leaders

谓语: said

宾语从句1: special educational needs (Send) coordinators had worked through the summer to deal with the influx of requests for assessments

主语: special educational needs (Send) coordinators

谓语: had worked

时间状语: through the summer

目的状语: to deal with the influx of requests for assessments

状语从句: as secondary schools reported that many more year 7 students were arriving with EHCPs or applications

连词: as

主语: secondary schools

谓语: reported

宾语从句2: that many more year 7 students were arriving with EHCPs or applications

主语: many more year 7 students

谓语: were arriving

伴随状语: with EHCPs or applications

主语 "School leaders" 意为 "学校领导人"，谓语 "said" 意为 "表示/说"，后面接了一个宾语从句，说明他们所说的具体内容。宾语从句1的主干是 "special educational needs (Send) coordinators had worked through the summer"，即 "特殊教育需求 (Send) 协调员整个夏天都在工作"。目的状语 "to deal with the influx of requests for assessments" 说明工作的目的，意为 "处理如潮水般的/大量新增的评估申请"；其中

EHCPs, an additional 1.3 million have identified special needs, according to official data.

EHCP 是英格兰地方政府与家庭共同商定的法律文件，详细列明了 25 岁及以下儿童和年轻人所需的支持。他们能凭此获得额外资金援助或特殊学校入学名额。官方数据显示，目前有超过 53 万名学龄儿童持有 EHCP，另有 130 万名儿童已被确认存在特殊需求。

### 【 Para.6 】

The costs are met out of local authority high needs budgets but the huge growth in EHCPs has led to councils **amassing** sustained deficits, requiring a **statutory override** granted by central government to avoid many becoming technically bankrupt. Georgia Gould, the schools minister overseeing the changes, said the government was carefully considering the responses to its white paper, which aims to give children earlier diagnosis and intervention, and moderate the need for EHCPs.

相关开支由地方政府的高需求专项预算承担。但 EHCP 数量激增，造成多地议会财政赤字不断累积，需要中央政府授予法定豁免，才能避免陷入技术性破产。负责本次改革的学校事务大臣乔治亚·古尔德（Georgia Gould）表示，政府正在审慎研究各界对其白皮书的反馈。该白皮书旨在让儿童尽早获得诊断与干预，减少对 EHCP 的需求。

### 【 Para.7 】

“the influx of requests for assessments” 里，influx意为“涌入、激增”，requests for assessments即“评估申请”。随后由“as”引导一个状语从句，表示“同时/随着”，引出另一情况：“secondary schools reported that...”，即“中学报告说.....”。在这个状语从句中，reported后接that引导的宾语从句2，主语是“many more year 7 students”，谓语是“were arriving”，意为“越来越多的七年级学生到来”，伴随状语“with EHCPs or applications”则说明他们带着EHCP或申请入学。

### ➤ 写作积累

1.(Para.3) Such a rapid rise would outstrip the government's own forecasts and eat into funding for improving specialist support in mainstream schools, undermining plans for reform while straining school and council budgets.

eat into funding 即“挤占资金”或“消耗资金”，指某事物逐渐占用原本可用于其他用途的资金。

例句：Rising rental costs eat into the company's profit. 不断上涨的租金正在侵蚀这家公司的利润。

与之相近的短语还包括：

cut into: The new taxes will cut into our profits. 新税收将挤占我们的利润。

erode: Rising costs are eroding our savings. 不断上涨的成本正在侵蚀我们的积蓄。

encroach on: These expenses encroach on the budget for teaching. 这些开支挤占了教学预算

2.(Para.10) Paul Whiteman, the general secretary of the National Association of Head Teachers, said the reports of increases in EHCPs chimed with “what we hear from school leaders” .

chime with 与..... 相吻合、和..... 一致，多用于观点、说法、消息等语境。

例句：These survey results chime with public observations. 这些调研结果与公众的观察相吻合。

与之相近的短语还包括：

accord with: His view accords with scientific evidence. 他的观点与科学证据相一致。

be consistent with: The data is consistent with previous research. 该数据与先前的研究保持一致。

The white paper's timeline would result in more children with individual support plans alongside

increased support in mainstream schools; while EHCPs would be designed for those with more **profound** needs and disabilities from 2030.

按照白皮书的时间规划，未来更多儿童将获得个性化支持方案，普通学校的配套帮扶也会加强；而从 2030 年起，EHCP 将主要面向有更重度特殊需求及残障的人群。

### 【 Para.8 】

During a visit to Thomas Lord Audley secondary school in Colchester, Gould said parts of the planned changes would begin operating this year, including the government's new "experts in hand" scheme that puts specialists directly into mainstream schools and nurseries. "I've spoken to parents around the country, and lots of families and children have been really let down by the system," Gould said. "So they are really concerned, and any change can feel worrying for those families."

古尔德在视察科尔切斯特的托马斯·洛德·奥德利中学时表示，部分改革举措将于今年实施，其中包括政府新推出的“专家驻校”项目——即直接向普通学校与幼儿保育机构派驻专业特教人员。古尔德说：“我和全国各地的家长沟通过，很多家庭与孩子对现有体系深感失望。因此他们十分焦虑，任何政策变动都会令这些家庭感到不安。”

### 【 Para.9 】

"That's why we want to put in place **tangible** change they can see and feel in classrooms and in their communities. And we've been clear we will build a new and **inclusive** system before we bring in wider changes." Gould acknowledged it was "going to take time to build that trust, to work with families for them to see that day to day. All the work we are doing, the investment, the teacher training, the sharing of best practice, is so important."

古尔德坦言：“正因如此，我们希望推出实实在在的改革，让他们在课堂、社区里真切看到、感受到变化。我们已经明确，在大范围推行改革之前，会先搭建一套全新的包容性教育体系。建立信任需要时间，需要和家庭协同合作，让他们一天天地看到改变。我们开展的所有工作，资金投入、教师培训以及优秀实践经验的共享，都至关重要。”

### 【 Para.10 】

Paul Whiteman, the general secretary of the National Association of Head Teachers, said the reports of increases in EHCPs chimed with "what we hear from school leaders". Whiteman said: "While it is hard to give a definitive reason for why this is happening, it appears likely that the government's plans to restrict future EHCPs to children with the most complex needs may have led to more families and schools applying before these changes kick in."

全国校长协会的秘书长保罗·怀特曼 (Paul Whiteman) 表示, EHCP 申请激增的报道与“各校负责人反馈的情况”相吻合。怀特曼称: “虽然很难确定申请激增的确切原因, 但很可能是因为政府计划今后仅向需求最复杂的儿童提供 EHCP, 这促使更多家庭和学校赶在新政生效前提交申请。”

### 【Para.11】

The surge in applications has led some local authorities to dramatically raise their own forecasts.

A report by Hampshire council in July showed applications so far this year were at record levels and forecast a 58% rise in EHCPs between 2026 and 2030. Manchester council is also anticipating a 40% increase in school-age children with EHCPs by 2029. 申请潮使得部分地方政府大幅上调预测数据。汉普郡议会 7 月的一份报告显示, 截至当时, 本年度的申请量已创历史新高, 预计 2026-2030 年间, EHCP 数量将上涨 58%。曼彻斯特议会也预测, 到 2029 年, 持有该计划的学龄儿童将增加 40%。